

JULY 28

President Johnson announces that 50,000 more ground troops are to be sent to Vietnam—requiring an increase in the draft to 35,000 per month.



Badge supporting US troops

AUGUST 18–24

US Marines launch a strike against the Viet Cong in Operation Starlite: the first major offensive operation by US ground forces in Vietnam.

NOVEMBER 2

American Quaker Norman Morrison burns himself to death in front of the Pentagon in protest of the Vietnam War.

NOVEMBER 14–17

US Air Cavalry fight North Vietnamese troops in the Battle of Ia Drang. A battalion of the Cavalry is ambushed by NVA forces at landing zone X-Ray.

DECEMBER 31

At the year's end there are 184,000 American troops in Vietnam. The American death toll for the year totals 1,928.